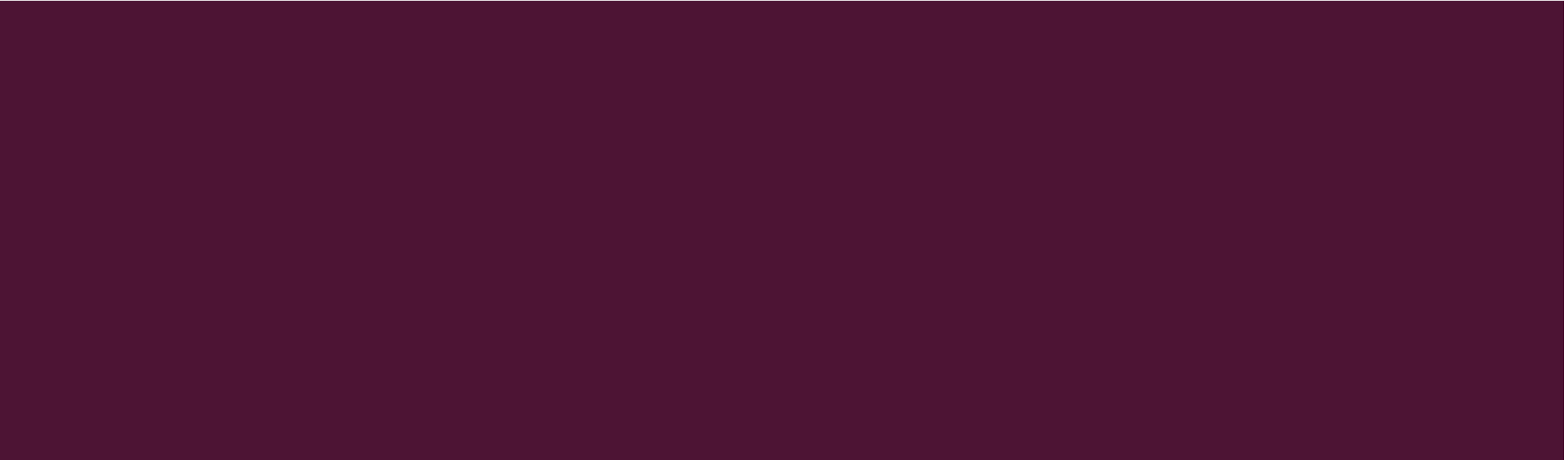




ROUTINE BUSINESS CORRESPONDENCE

MEMOS, LETTERS, EMAILS,



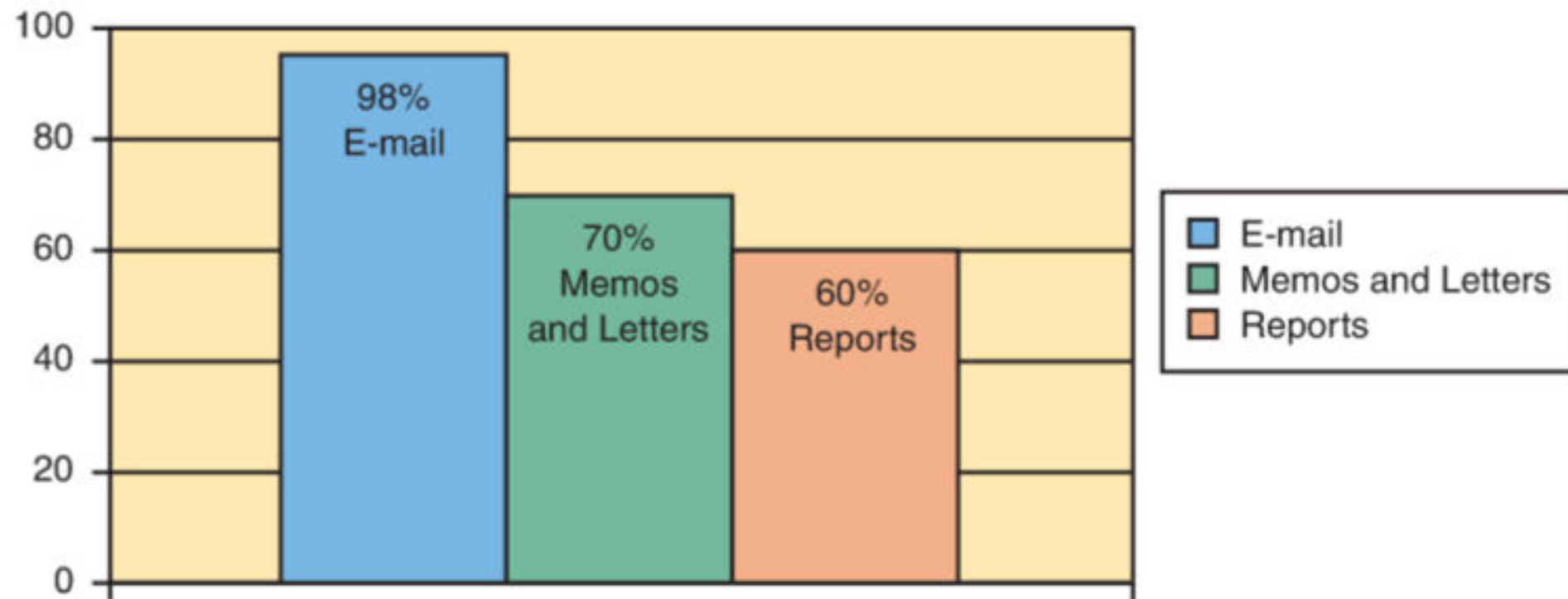
COMMUNICATION CHANNELS IN THE WORKPLACE

- Letters
- Emails
- Memos
- Reports (long and short)
- Websites
- Blogs/vlogs
- PowerPoint presentations
- Oral or face to face communication
- Instant messaging, text messaging
- Podcasts

QUESTION

- When should you write an email instead of a memo?
- When is a memo preferred to a letter?
- What are the situation to which instant messages are better suited?

FIGURE 6.1 Percentage of Employees Who Consider E-mail, Memos, Letters, and Reports "Extremely Important"



CHAPTER 6

DIFFERENCES AMONG MEDIUMS

Characteristics	Memos	Letters	E-mail	IM/TM
Destination	Internal: correspondence written to colleagues within a company.	External: correspondence written outside the business.	Internal and external: correspondence written to friends and acquaintances, co-workers within a company, and clients and vendors.	Internal and external: correspondence written to friends and acquaintances, co-workers within a company, and clients and vendors.



Characteristics	Memos	Letters	E-mail	IM/TM
Format	Identification lines include "Date," "To," "From," and "Subject." The message follows.	Includes letterhead address, date, reader's address, salutation, text, complimentary close, and signatures.	Identification lines: To and Subject. The Date and From are computer generated. Options include cc (complimentary copy), forwarding the e-mail message to others, and replying to numerous readers.	No format.



Characteristics	Memos	Letters	E-mail	IM/TM
Audience	Generally high tech or low tech, mostly business colleagues.	Generally low-tech and lay readers, such as vendors, clients, stakeholders, and stockholders.	Multiple readers due to the internal and external nature of e-mail.	Multiple readers due to the internal and external nature of IM and TM.



Characteristics	Memos	Letters	E-mail	IM/TM
Topic	Generally topics related to internal corporate information; abbreviations and acronyms often allowed.	Generally topics related to vendor, client, stakeholder, and stockholder interests; abbreviations and acronyms usually defined.	A wide range of diverse topics determined by the audience.	A wide range of diverse topics determined by the audience.



Characteristics	Memos	Letters	E-mail	IM/TM
Complexity and length of communication	Memos usually are limited to a page of text. If you need to write longer correspondence and develop a topic in more detail, you might consider using a different communication channel, such as a short report.	Letters usually are limited to a page of text, though you might write a two- or three-page report using a letter format. If you need to develop a topic in greater detail than can be conveyed in one to three pages, you might want to use a different communication channel, such as a longer, formal report.	An effective e-mail message usually is limited to one viewable screen (requiring no scrolling) or two screens. E-mail, generally, is not the best communication channel to use for complex information or long correspondence. If your topic demands more depth than can be conveyed in a screen or two, you might want to write a report instead.	IM and TM are very brief communication channels. Text messages must be limited to 160 characters. The typical size of an instant message is around 200 characters. Generally, the maximum size for mobile messages is approximately 400 characters.



Characteristics	Memos	Letters	E-mail	IM/TM
Tone	Informal due to peer audience.	More formal due to audience of vendors, clients, stakeholders, and stockholders.	A wide range of tones due to diverse audiences. Usually informal when written to friends, informal to co-workers, more formal to management or external readers.	Very informal due to the limits placed on size.



Characteristics	Memos	Letters	E-mail	IM/TM
Attachments or enclosures	Hard-copy attachments can be stapled to the memo. Complimentary copies (cc) can be sent to other readers.	Additional information can be enclosed within the envelope. Complimentary copies (cc) can be sent to other readers.	Computer word processing files, HTML files and Web links, PDF files, RTF files, or downloadable graphics can be attached to e-mail. Complimentary copies can be sent to other readers.	Attachments can be sent using IM. You can send photo attachments with TM. However, sending file attachments with TM is limited.



Characteristics	Memos	Letters	E-mail	IM/TM
Delivery time	Determined by a company's in-house mail procedure.	Determined by the destination (within the city, state, or country). Letters could be delivered within three days but may take more than a week.	Often instantaneous, usually within minutes. Delays can be caused by system malfunctions or excessively large attachments.	Instantaneous.



FIGURE 6.2 All-Purpose Template for Memos, Letters, and E-mail

Introduction: A lead-in or overview stating why you are writing and what you are writing about.

Discussion: Detailed development, made accessible through highlighting techniques, explaining exactly what you want to say.

-
-
-

Conclusion: State what is next, when this will occur, and why the date is important.

FAQs: Memos vs. E-mail

Q: Why write a memo? Haven't memos been replaced by e-mail?

A: E-mail is rapidly overtaking memos in the workplace, but employees still write memos for the following reasons:

1. Not all employees work in offices or have access to computers. Many employees who work in warehouses or in the field cannot easily access an e-mail account. They must depend on hard-copy documentation like memos.
2. Not all companies have e-mail. This may be hard to believe in the twenty-first century, but still it's a fact. These companies depend on hard-copy documentation like memos.
3. Many unions demand that hard-copy memos be posted on walls, in break rooms, in offices, and elsewhere, to ensure that all employees have access to important information. Sometimes, unions even demand that employees initial the posted memos, thus acknowledging that the memos have been read.
4. Some information cannot be transmitted electronically via e-mail. A bank we've worked with, for example, sends hard-copy cancelled checks as attachments to memos. They cannot send the actual cancelled check via e-mail.
5. E-mail messages are very easy to disregard. We get so many e-mail messages (many of them spam) that we tend to quickly delete them. Memos, in contrast, make more of an official statement. People might take hard-copy memos more seriously than e-mail messages.

MEMOS

- Intra office communication
- Mostly hard copy correspondence
- A wide range of readership
- Purposes:
 - Documentation – expenses, incidents, accidents, problems, projected costs, relocation of staff, announcements
 - Confirmation – meetings, agenda, date and time location etc.
 - Procedures – how to setup accounts, use new software etc.
 - Status – short progress reports or projections
 - Directive – delegation of responsibilities

COMPONENTS OF A MEMO

- Heading
- Memo identification lines (Date, To, From and Subject)
- Introduction
- Discussion
- Conclusion
- Audience recognition
- Appropriate memo style and tone



Memorandum

Heading

Date: December 30, 2014

To: Mr. Hamad Ahmad, VP of sales

 Identification lines

From: Junaid Ahmad

Subject: Attendance at Time Management Seminar

SUBJECT LINE

BEFORE

Subject: Sales

AFTER

Subject: Report on Quarterly Sales

- A summarization of the memo's contents

INTRODUCTION

- Write one or two clear introductory sentences telling your reader **what** topic you are writing about and **why** you are writing

EXAMPLE ►

In the third of our series of sales quota meetings this quarter, I'd like to review our productivity.

DISCUSSION

- This section allows content to be developed specifically.
- Readers might not be inclined to read each line.
- Blocks of data (paragraphs) might not be effective.
- Make text reader friendly by:
 - Itemizing
 - Boldfacing
 - Headings
 - Graphics

BEFORE

Example—Unfriendly Text

This year began with an increase, as we sold 4.5 million units in January compared to 3.7 for January 2012. In February we continued to improve with 4.6, compared with 3.6 for the same time in 2012. March was not quite so good, as we sold 4.3 against the March 2012 figure of 3.9. April was about the same with 4.2, compared to 3.8 for April 2012.

AFTER

Example—Reader-Friendly Text

Comparative Quarterly Sales (in Millions)

	2012	2013	Increase/Decrease
--	------	------	-------------------

Jan.	3.7	4.5	0.8+
Feb.	3.6	4.6	1.0+
Mar.	3.9	4.3	0.4+
Apr.	3.8	4.2	0.4+

CONCLUSION

- Conclude with gratitude (thanks) and/or directive action
- Directive conclusion tells your reader exactly what you want them to do

EXAMPLE ►

If our quarterly sales continue to improve at the current rate, we will double our sales expectations by 2012. Next Wednesday (12/22/12), please provide next quarter's sales projections and a summary of your sales team's accomplishments.



MEMORANDUM

DATE: November 17, 2021

TO: All Employees

FROM: Emma Johnson, VP, Marketing Department

SUBJECT: Facilities Update

I'm writing to inform you that, over the next few weeks, our kitchen area will be under construction as we re-model.

As our company continues to grow, we feel it necessary to provide more communal dining space, and we are grateful to our facilities team for their hard work in making that happen.

If you have questions or concerns regarding the re-model, you can access the full report [here](#). In the meantime, we are sorry for the inconvenience.

In between the weeks of December 1 - December 31, please use the kitchen on the second floor if you need a microwave. We will also keep that kitchen stocked per usual with snacks and soda.

Thank you for your cooperation.



MEMORANDUM

DATE: February 15, 2022

TO: Our Valued Community Member

FROM: Massachusetts State Board of Elections

SUBJECT: In-Person Early Voting Beginning in Two Weeks

We're writing to inform you that in-person early voting is to begin in two weeks for the Democratic and Republican state primary elections.

Please familiarize yourself with early voting site locations, schedules, and candidate biography and interests all available through the State Board of Elections [one-stop site look up tool](#).

If you have any questions, please contact our office at [official phone number]. We appreciate your cooperation as your voice matters in this election process.

AUDIENCE RECOGNITION

- Letters go outside of your organization:
 - Audience could be lay or low-tech
 - Define terms specifically
- Memos are in-house:
 - Possibility of using more acronyms
 - You might CC (complementary copy) to multiple lay, low tech & high-tech readers
 - To accommodate use parenthetical definitions (recall previous lecture)

STYLE AND TONE

Style

- Simple words
- Short sentences
- Specific details
- Highlighting techniques

Tone

- Audience determines tone
- Can you sound directive or demanding to your boss?
- Do not be dictatorial
- Keep things friendly and informal

BEFORE

Example 1—Unfriendly, Demanding Style

We will have a meeting next Tuesday, Jan. 11, 2012. Exert every effort to attend this meeting. Plan to make intelligent comments regarding the new quarter projections.

AFTER

Example 2—Friendly, Personal Style

Let's meet next Tuesday (Jan. 11, 2012). Even if you're late, I'd appreciate your attending. By doing so you can have an opportunity to make an impact on the second quarter projections. I'm looking forward to hearing your comments.

Types of Memos

```
graph TD; A[Types of Memos] --- B(Request Memo); A --- C(Confirmation Memo); A --- D(Informal Study results Memo); A --- E(Ideas & suggestions Memo);
```

Request
Memo

Confirmation
Memo

Informal Study
results Memo

Ideas & suggestions
Memo

TYPES OF MEMOS

- Request memo
- The objective of a request memo is to gain a favorable response to a request. The memo must be written in a convincing way. Consider the following case.
- an employee wants to attend a time management training program that will be sponsored by the chamber of commerce at a local hotel



SUBJECT: Attendance at Time Management Seminar

As I discussed with you last week, the Chamber of Commerce is sponsoring a Time Management seminar. It is being conducted by one of the professors of the Management Science department at FAST. The participation fee is only Rs. 1000/- for the entire day.

For the last six months I have been working without an assistant. A Time Management seminar would help me improve my productivity and reduce some of the backlog. The attached brochure presents the content of the seminar.

Considering the value of the training and low cost to the firm, I would like approval to attend the seminar. Registration closes on Wednesday, 4 March, 2020. I am sure that the enrollment cap of 30 will be filled before the end of this week. May I hear from you before Friday?

- 
- a. The request should be clearly stated
 - b. The reasons for the request should be presented.
 - c. If any financial costs are involved, they should be explained.
 - d. All expenses should be justified.
 - e. Recommendations for action should be presented.
 - f. Throughout the memo tact and diplomacy should be used.

If the memo is persuasively written, it should be easy for the reader to say “yes.” As in the above example – showing indirect and direct benefits to the company (i.e., reader oriented).



Confirmation Memo

- A confirmation memo is designed to confirm in writing something that has been agreed to verbally. Consider, for example, the sales manager who promises to provide sales coverage to six more cities if the general manager provides him with three additional salespeople.
- When the general manager and the sales manager agree on this plan of action, it is common to find the general manager confirming this agreement with a memo.



SUBJECT: Hiring New Salesperson

This is the confirmation of our June 8, during we agreed to hire new salespeople to expand the focus of the sales coverage of your region. Here are the specific points on which we agreed.

- 1) Three new salespeople of a southern region to be hired. This sales people will be on board by July 1st, and in the field by July 15th.
- 2) These people may be paid up to rupees 15000/- per month and will receive the standard 10% commission.
- 3) These three people will spend the first month in the field, where they will learn how we sell our products. Then they will each be given a territory.

If you have any questions, please call me. If I don't hear from you within a week, I will assume that this memo accurately reflects our conversation and you are taking steps to hire the three salesperson.

IDEAS AND SUGGESTIONS MEMO



MEMO TO ALL EMPLOYEES
PLEASE USE THE EMPLOYEE SUGGESTION
BOX ONLY TO SUBMIT IDEAS THAT CAN BE
IMPLEMENTED WITHOUT MONEY, TIME, OR
EFFORT.



SUBJECT: Action for Reducing Absenteeism and Turnover.

Thank you for asking me the suggestion regarding absenteeism and turnover. The current rate of absenteeism is not much higher than the industry average, so we do not need to make radical changes. However, I believe we should take the following steps.

COMPETITIVE SALARIES:

In most jobs we are paying competitive salaries. However we are below the industry average in our wage for incoming secretarial help and for unit managers. We must raise their salary to those of the competition.

BENEFIT PACKAGES:

Our health benefit package is too limited. The package provide only minimal assistance to our routine expenses. Over 40 percent of people are leavening our firm. We need a package as good as our competitors.



Informal Study Results Memo

- Organizational personnel are sometimes asked to write the results of an informal study in a memo. The objective of the message is to present the information in an easy-to-read, understandable form. To this end, follow the guidelines listed below:
 - a. State the purpose at the beginning (and stick to it).
 - b. Use headings and sub-headings to make the reading as easy as possible. Present data in a “**Findings**” section and interpret it in another called “**Conclusions**” (or other similar terms).
 - c. Be specific. Stay on the point and address different issues one by one, systematically.
 - d. Unless there is good reason to do otherwise, write the memo in informal language and use personal pronouns.

SUBJECT: Review of Customer Complaints.

In your response to the request, I have examined a large number of customer complaints we have recently received about our compact electrical hair blower. In all there were 150 letters or postcards.

FINDINGS:

Product quality: Two-third of the letters reported that the product quality is poor. Major complaints are about plastic casing cracks and customer are afraid to use it.

Refund: Second complaint is that it is difficult to obtain refunds. 39% of letter address this complain.

Price: Third most common plain is that prices are too high.

RECOMMENDATIONS:

Based on the findings, we need to take three steps.

1. Create a team of engineers, product design personnel, and manufacturing people to examine a sample of the returned product. The group should also ensure how the production cost can be reduced.
2. Send a letter to retailer selling our product to inform them that we will replace or repurchase all the units.
3. Have the marketing people review our prices.

I will be happy to discuss these ideas with you in further detail.

LETTERS

- External correspondence
- Letters reflect not only your communicative abilities but also create an impression of your company

ESSENTIAL LETTER COMPONENTS

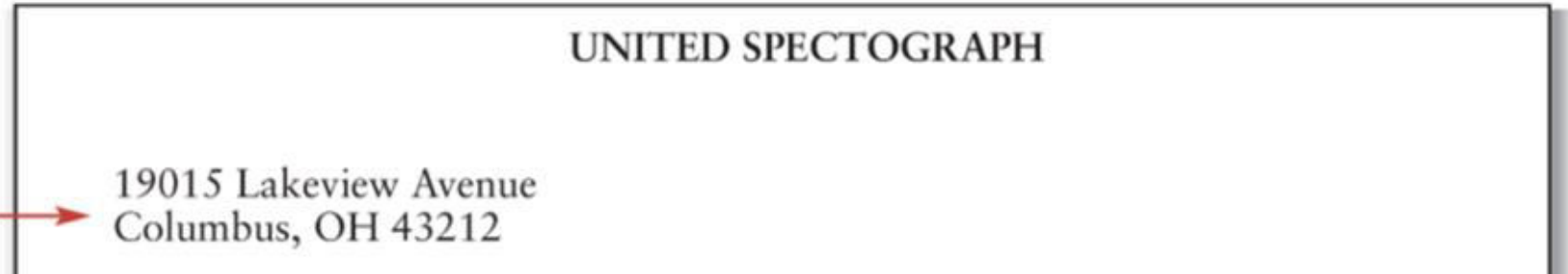
8 ½ “ x 11” (inch) or A4 size paper

1” to 1 ½” margin on all sides

Recommended fonts: Times New Roman, Arial, Calibri

Avoid fonts like Comic Sans

FIGURE 6.6 Essential Letter Components



Date

June 10, 2012

Reader's address

Kristy Piburn
Corporate Communications, Inc.
1245 Grant
Chicago, IL 60611

Salutation

Dear Ms. Piburn:

Letter text

Here is the schedule for your presentation during our Basic Information Training for Supervisors (BITS) seminar. You will hold your sessions in our Training Center at 19015 Lakeview Avenue.

The schedule and important information regarding your two, 8-hour seminars are as follows:

- Group 1, consisting of 15 employees, will meet Monday, July 6, 2012, from 8:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m.
- Group 2, consisting of 18 employees, will meet Tuesday, July 7, 2012, from 8:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m.

As you requested, the training room will have a computer, overhead projection system, screen, flip chart, and pad. During the morning sessions, coffee, juice, and rolls will be served. In the afternoon, seminar participants will be offered cold drinks and cookies. We look forward to working with you again. If I can answer any questions, please let me know.

Complimentary close

Sincerely,

Signed name

Martha Lee

Typed name

Martha Lee

STANDARD PARTS OF A BUSINESS LETTER

■ Most Business Letters have following parts:

1. Heading-Letterhead (sender's address)
2. Date
3. Inside Address (receiver's address)
4. Reference lines (Attention, Confidential, and Subject)
5. Courtesy Title and Name or Salutation
6. Body
7. Complimentary Close
8. Signature Area



Attention: Application Examiner

Re: Request for confidentiality
Applicant: Alco Electronics Ltd.
FCC ID: A2HW1013

To whom it may concern,

Permanent Confidentiality

Request is hereby submitted by ALCO ELECTRONICS LTD. to withhold permanently from public review certain portions of the application for equipment certification for the referenced FCC identifiers. This request for confidentiality is made pursuant to 47 CFR 0.457(d) & 0.459 of the FCC Rules. In particular, the following sections of the application are to be kept permanently confidential:

- Schematics
- Detailed Block diagrams
- Detailed Operational/Functional Description

Rationale for request for confidentiality:

Alco Electronics Ltd. has invested considerable time and materials in research and development to produce the referenced product. Disclosure of the permanently confidential portions of this application to competitors would not only give them significant competitive advantages in developing similar products, but would also disclose successful implementation of unpublished, leading edge technology developed by us.

The fee for confidentiality has been submitted along with the fee for certification. If you have questions or need further information, please contact the undersigned.

Sincerely,



for Peggy Suen

Peggy Suen,
Secretary, E/G Dept.
Alco Electronics Ltd.



■ **Optional Parts of the Letter**

■ When appropriate, any of these optional parts can be included:

1. Subject line/ Attention line
2. New page notation
3. Enclosure Notation
4. Copy Notation CC

Subject/ Attention line

- Attention and subject are typed below the inside address (receiver's address)

Mr. Ahmad Mukhtar, Sales Manager
National Foods
6.7 Multan Road
Lahore

Human Resource Department
Touchstone Communication
Office 23, Evacuee Trust
F-5/I, Islamabad

Subject: Delivery of tomatoes from Iran

Attention: G. Rabbani, HR Manager

New page notation

Left, margin, subsequent page notation	Across top of subsequent pages
Mabel Tinjaca Page 2 May 31, 2014	Mabel Tinjaca Page 2 May 31, 2014

◀ EXAMPLE

Enclosure/ Copy Notation

ROUTINE CORRESPONDENCE

EXAMPLE ►

Sincerely,
Brian Altman
Brian Altman
Enclosure: August Status Report
cc: Marcia Rittmaster and Larry Rochelle

LETTER FORMATS

■ **Full block** : Every component of the letter is aligned to the left.

SAMPLE INTERNSHIP APPLICATION LETTER

543 Willow Drive
Terre Haute, IN 47802
812-555-7777

March 19, 2009

Mr. John Miller
Data Processing Manager
Industrial Outlet Corporation
293 Corporate Square
Terre Haute, IN 47803

Dear Mr. Miller:

Please consider me for the Information System Administrator Internship that was listed with the Indiana State University Career Center. This internship is of great interest to me as it reflects my career goals and requires my education, skills, and experience.

With majors in mathematics and computer science, I have extensive knowledge of database design and computer programming. In addition, elective courses in finance have provided knowledge of forecasting, evaluating ratios, and analyzing complex and detailed financial information. Moreover, working as a Student Assistant in the IT Lab at Indiana State University developed my ability to communicate ideas clearly and enhanced my skills in troubleshooting software and hardware problems. I feel these skills would allow me to perform effectively in this position. My enclosed resume outlines my experience in greater detail.

I welcome the opportunity to meet with you and appreciate your consideration. Should you need additional information, you may reach me at (812) 555-7777. I hope to speak with you soon.

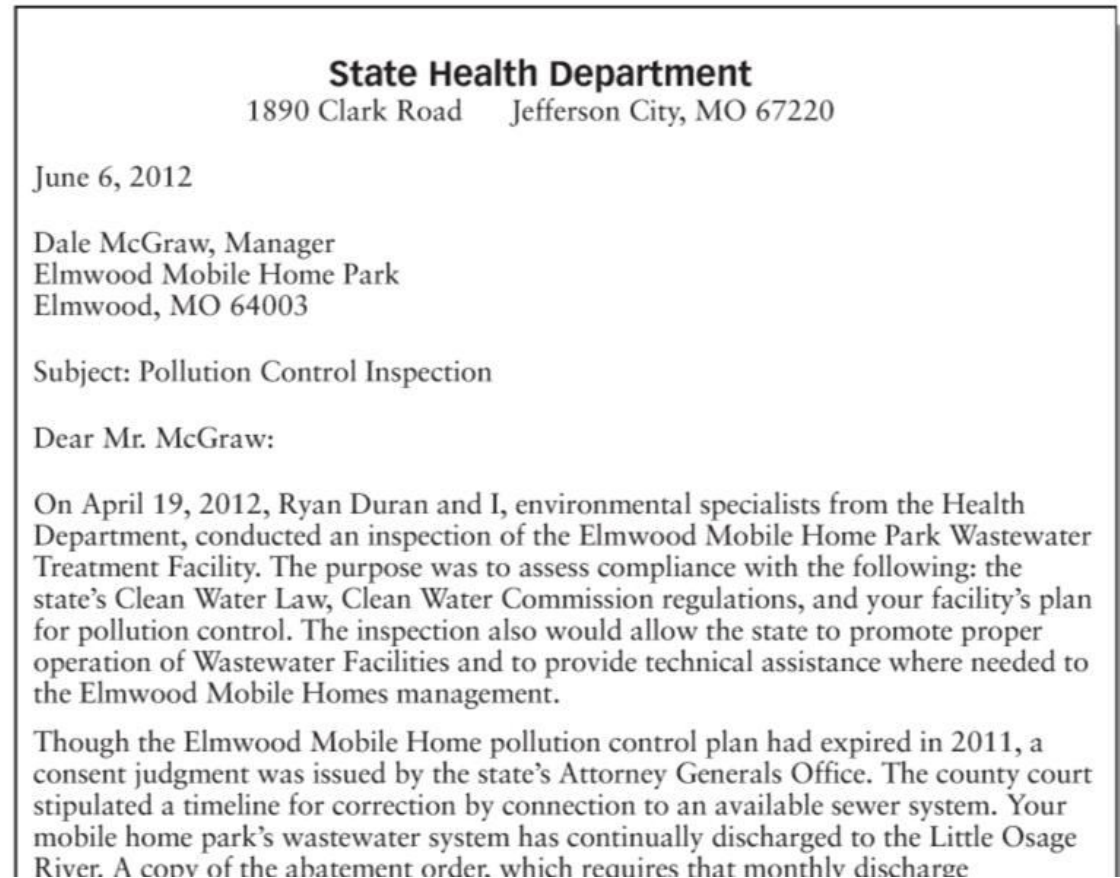
Sincerely,

Chris Austen

Enclosure

FULL BLOCK WITH SUBJECT

FIGURE 6.8 Full Block Format with Subject Line



TYPES OF LETTERS

- Inquiry
- Transmittal
- Complaint
- Bad news
- Confirmation
- Recommendation
- Consider using the all purpose template given above

THREE PARTS OF LETTERS AND EMAILS

Introduction

Discussion/body

Conclusion

INQUIRY

■ Information about:

- Degree requirements
- Equipment
- Costs
- Performance records
- Employee credentials etc.

BEFORE

Dear Mr. Jernigan:

Please send us information about the following filter pools:

1. East Lime Pool
2. West Sulphate Pool
3. East Aggregate Pool

Thank you.

The reader replied as follows:

Dear Mr. Scholl:

I would be happy to provide you with any information you would like. However, you need to tell me what information you require about the pools.

I look forward to your response.

ROUTINE CORRESPONDENCE—MEMOS, LETTERS, E-MAIL MESSAGES, INSTANT MESSAGES

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Technical Communication: Process and Product, Seventh Edition, by Sharon J. Gerson and Steven M. Gerson. Published by Prentice Hall.
Copyright © 2012 by Pearson Education, Inc.

Providing specific details makes your letter of inquiry effective. You will save your readers time by quantifying your request.

The first writer, recognizing the error, rewrote the letter as follows:

AFTER

Dear Mr. Jernigan:

My company, Jackson County Hazardous Waste Disposal, Inc., needs to purchase new waste receptacles. One of our clients used your products in the past and recommended you. Please send us information about the following:

1. Lime Pool—costs, warranties, time of installation, and dimensions
2. Sulphate Pool—costs, material, and levels of acidity
3. Aggregate Pool—costs, flammability, maintenance, and discoloration

We plan to install our pools by March 12. We would appreciate your response by February 20. Thank you.

LETTER OF INQUIRY

- Introduction
 - Clarify intent and purpose for writing to avoid confusion
 - State your intent and subject matter in one to three sentences
- Body
 - Ask precise question
 - List specific topics of inquiry
- Conclusion
 - Specify exactly when you need a response
 - Provide concrete dates and times whenever possible

Refer to the letter of inquiry on page 173 of your textbook

FIGURE 4 Letter of Inquiry

COMRMed

8713 Hillview Reno, NV 32901 1-800-551-9000 Fax: 1-816-555-0000

September 12, 2014

Sales Manager
OfficeToGo
7622 Raintree
St. Louis, MO 66772

Subject: Request for Product Pricing and Shipping Schedules

My medical technology company has worked well with OfficeToGo for the past five years. However, in August I received a letter informing me that OTG had been purchased by a larger corporation. I need to determine if OTG remains competitive with other major office equipment suppliers in the Reno area.

Please provide the following information:

1. What discounts will be offered for bulk purchases?
2. Which freight company will OTG now be using?
3. Who will pay to insure the items ordered?
4. What is the turnaround time from order placement to delivery?
5. Will OTG be able to deliver to all my satellite sites?
6. Will OTG technicians set up the equipment delivered, including desks, file cabinets, bookshelves, and chairs?
7. Will OTG be able to personalize office stationery onsite, or will it have to be outsourced?

Please respond to these questions by September 30 so I can prepare my quarterly orders in a timely manner. I continue to expand my insurance agency and want assurances that you can fill my growing office supply needs. You can contact me at the phone number provided above or by e-mail (jgood@COMRMed.com).

Jim Goodwin

Jim Goodwin
Owner and CEO

In the introduction, briefly explaining why you are writing establishes the context of the inquiry for the audience.

A detailed and itemized list informs the audience the exact questions you need answered. If you write precise questions, the audience will be able to provide the information you are requesting.

Pleasantly state when and why you need a response by a specific date to encourage your audience. In the conclusion, you can also include detailed contact information not provided in the letterhead.

COVER OR TRANSMITTAL LETTER

- You are often required to send information to clients, vendors or colleagues
- Cover or transmittal letter serves as a preface for that information
 - readers know up front what they are receiving
 - Focuses reader attention on specific/key points in the enclosed document(s)

CONTINUED

- Introduction
 - Why you are writing
 - What you are writing about
 - What if the reader has asked you to send the documentation, do you still need to explain why your are writing?
 - YES!
- Body
 - Tell reader exactly what you have enclosed
 - Or what is of value to the reader in the enclosure
 - Provide itemized lists and short paragraphs

CONTINUED

- Conclusion
 - Tell reader what you want next
 - When do you want it and why is that important
- Cover/ transmittal letter on page 174 of your textbook

FIGURE 6 Cover Memo Prefacing Attachments

Date: November 11, 2014
To: COMRMed Management
From: Bill Baker, Human Resources Director
Subject: Information about Proposed Changes to Employee Benefits Package

As of January 1, 2015, COMRMed will change insurance carriers. This will affect all 5,000 employees' benefits packages. I have attached a proposal, including the following:

- | | |
|--|-----------|
| 1. Reasons for changing from our current carrier | page 2 |
| 2. Criteria for our selection of a new insurance company | pages 3–4 |
| 3. Monthly cost for each employee | pages 5–6 |
| 4. Overall cost to COMRMed | page 7 |
| 5. Benefits derived from the new healthcare plan | page 8 |

Please review the proposal, survey your employees' responses to our suggestions, and provide your feedback. We need your input by December 1, 2014. This will give the human resources department time to consider your suggestions and work with insurance companies to meet employee needs.

Enclosure: Proposal

A cover memo directs the reader to the content in an attachment, such as a proposal. You can summarize the most important parts of the proposal, providing page numbers. In addition, your memo can include dated action so that the reader knows what to do next.

COMPLAINT LETTERS

- Introduction
 - Politely state the problem
 - add supporting details (date of purchase, price of product, serial number, invoice number, outlet etc)
 - Be diplomatic and suppress your anger
- Discussion
 - Explain the problem in detail.
 - Add shipping details, immediate measure taken
- Conclusion
 - End on a positive note
 - Be courteous
 - Include contact information

Complaint letter on page 175 of textbook

FIGURE 7 Complaint Letter

1234 18th Street
Galveston, TX 77001
May 10, 2014

Mr. Holbert Lang
Customer Service Manager
Gulfstream Auto
1101 21st Street
Galveston, TX 77001

Dear Mr. Lang:

On February 12, I purchased two shock absorbers in your automotive department. Enclosed are copies of the receipt and the warranty for that purchase. One of those shocks has since proved defective.

I attempted to exchange the defective shock at your store on May 2. The mechanic on duty, Vernon Blanton, informed me that the warranty was invalid because your service staff did not install the part. I believe that your company should honor the warranty agreement and replace the part for the following reasons:

1. The warranty states that the shock is covered for 48 months and 48,000 miles.
2. The warranty does not state that installation by someone other than the dealership will result in warranty invalidation.
3. The defective shock absorber is causing potentially expensive damage to the tire and suspension system.

I can be reached between 1 p.m. and 6 p.m. on weekdays at 763-9280 or at 763-9821 anytime on weekends. You also can email me at cdelatorre12@hotmail.com. I look forward to hearing from you. Thank you for helping me with this misunderstanding.

Sincerely,

Carlos De La Torre

Carlos De La Torre

Enclosures (2)

The introduction includes the date of purchase (to substantiate the claim) and the problems encountered.

The body explains what happened, states what the writer wants done, and justifies the request. This letter develops its claim with warranty information.

The letter concludes by providing contact information and an upbeat, pleasant tone.

Adjustment messages

TABLE 2 Differences Among Adjustment Messages

	100 Percent Yes	100 Percent No	Partial Adjustment
Introduction	State the good news.	Begin with a buffer, a comment agreeable to both reader and writer.	State the good news.
Discussion	Explain what happened and what the reader should do and/or what the company plans to do next.	Explain what happened, state the bad news, and provide possible alternatives.	Explain what happened, state the bad news, and provide possible alternatives—what the reader and/or company should do next.
Conclusion	End upbeat and positive.	Resell (provide discounts, coupons, follow-up contact names and numbers, etc.) to maintain good will.	Resell (provide discounts, coupons, etc.) to maintain good will.

BAD NEWS LETTERS

- Always be tactful while conveying bad news
- Introduction
 - Clarity and conciseness might be harsh and abrupt in a bad news letter
 - Begin with information that is neutral, positive or something that can be accepted as valid
- Discussion
 - State the bad news using neutral wording
 - Give concrete proof for your rejection
- Conclusion
 - You still want to maintain a good relationship with the reader
 - Give a positive ending or opportunity for future success
 - Give options if possible
- Bad news letter on page 181 of textbook

Rejection letter #1

Date

[Name of Applicant]
Address
Address

Dear [Name of Applicant],

Thank you for applying for our job opening. After carefully reviewing your qualifications, we have decided to pursue other candidates whom we feel more closely meet our needs at this time.

We appreciate your interest in our company, and the time it took to apply with us. Please feel free to apply for open positions with us in the future.

Again, thank you for considering us as a potential employer. We wish you success in your career pursuit.

Sincerely,

[Hiring Manager]
[Title]

Company

Dear Mr. Bloodworth:

You have received three disciplinary notices within the past six months in conjunction with our conversations about your behavior. Unfortunately, we see no change in your performance. In the last year you have been late 33 times, absent without excuse on seven occasions, and late on all but one project deadline.

We rely on employees who are punctual and conscientious about attendance and deadlines. Our clients will look elsewhere if we cannot offer them dependable service. You have demonstrated an unacceptable pattern of behavior. Thus, we can no longer continue your employment at ACME Inc.

This decision is effective immediately. You will be paid two weeks salary.

Our policy is to give only title of position and dates of employment to companies seeking references. You can be assured the details of this situation will remain strictly a company matter.

We wish you the best in your future.

Sincerely,

CONFIRMATION LETTER

- Introduction
 - State context of the letter to avoid confusion
- Body
 - State details of the agreement
 - Use tables or bullet points wherever necessary
- Conclusion
 - Should tell the reader exactly what to do next
- Confirmation letter on page 182 of textbook

CONFIRMATION LETTER

Date: May 24, 2019

To,
[ATTN]
[ADDRESS]
[POSTAL CODE]
[COUNTRY]

Subject: Employment Confirmation Letter

To Whom It May Concern / Dear Mr., Mrs.,

We hereby confirm that [Applicant Name], born on [Date, Year] in [City], is employed full-time (39 hrs/week) as an administrative specialist since [Date, Year].

His areas of activities include (detailed description necessary), e.g.:

- Applying legislation in areas of the local government on an individual basis.
- Managing administrative and organizational tasks
- Dealing with processes in the areas of budgeting and accounting
- Taking on tasks in the area of personnel administration

If you have any questions, please feel free to contact me directly. I will be available on phone: [T+00000000] and email: [email@email.com] in case of any query.

Kind regards,

[NAME]

[Signature]

Recommendation letter

Recommendation Letter

You might write a letter of recommendation for many reasons:

- An employee deserves a promotion
- An ex-employee asks for a reference for a new job
- A colleague is nominated for an award
- An acquaintance is applying for an education scholarship
- A governmental agency is checking references
- A consultant requests a reference for a new client

When someone asks you to write a letter of recommendation, consider the *Do's* and *Don'ts* in Table 6.6.

Introduction. In the introduction, include any of the following:

- Your position (or title)
- Your relationship with the person
- The length of your relationship
- The applicant's name
- The position, scholarship, or award

Discussion. In the body, include the specific details of the applicant's skills:

- Examples of the applicant's job performance
- Illustrations proving how and why the person will benefit the company
- Evaluations of the person's chances of success in the company or program
- Differences from other people
- Examples of projects the applicant worked on
- Projects supervised
- Team skills
- Communication abilities
- Names of classes attended or certifications acquired to enhance the applicant's skills
- Honors earned at work, school, or military

Conclusion. In the conclusion, sum up why this person is deserving of consideration for the job, award, or scholarship. Be sure to include contact information, such as your telephone number or e-mail address. This will help the recipient of the recommendation letter reach you for a follow-up discussion.

Engineer Promotion Recommendation Letter

Mr. Geoffrey John
Managing Director,
Protext software Solutions,
California, US – 367496

Dear Mr. John,

I would like to take the opportunity to offer an official recommendation for Mr. Mark Smith as the senior executive of Protext software Solutions in California branch. I have known Mark for past 4 years and I feel that he is a deserving candidate for the post of Project Manager.

Mark joined our company 4 years back as a junior assistant tech support; with his immense knowledge over the subject and skilled abilities in his work, he gained the position of a Senior Executive in the team just after one year. And soon he was promoted as a team leader. He has been proving his mettle with every stepping stone he overleaf with his excellent leadership qualities. He has been an enthusiastic, inspiring and motivating leader. He has strong dedication and takes incredible initiative to do work effectively and efficiently.

I believe that Mark has all the abilities and qualities which are required for the position of a project manager. I highly recommend Mark Smith for the responsible post of a project manager and hope that you will carefully consider this letter of promotion.

Yours faithfully,
Ryan McCarthy.
Human Resource Manager

EMAIL

- Why email?
 - Time
 - Convenience
 - Can be used both internally and externally
 - Cost effective
 - Easier record keeping

FUNCTIONS EMAILS PERFORM

- Directive – to delegate work
- Cover/transmittal
- Confirmation
- Procedures – direct readers how to do things
- Recommendations
- Status – progress reports
- Inquiry

How is e-mail used and misused in business today?

Michael Smith, PE, President of George Butler Associates, Inc., an architectural-engineering consulting firm, supervises 270 employees, located in Kansas, Missouri, and Illinois. These include architects, engineers, scientists, and administrative support staff in human resources, marketing, information systems, and accounting.

Mike receives about 40 "meaningful e-mail" a day—and about 60 spam e-mail, attempting to tell him how to lose weight, buy gifts for his loved ones, make cost-effective travel arrangements, and so on. Mike deletes the spam, which is obvious at a glance in his e-mail inbox, and responds to the business-related correspondence.

He says that e-mail has been essential at GBA for at least two reasons:

The Good News:

1. **E-mail is fast and efficient.** For example, Mike finds that e-mail is ideal for setting up meetings with groups of individuals, including co-workers and clients. Before e-mail, he had to make multiple calls to his staff or customers, usually missing them while they were off-site. Or, he'd have to walk down the halls and up the stairs to leave messages on desks. Instead, with e-mail, Mike knows that the message will arrive at its intended location and that the recipients will respond.
2. **E-mail provides an "electronic record."** When GBA used to rely more heavily on the telephone, people had trouble remembering to document conversations. With e-mail, you have a communication trail: multiple e-mail messages



reporting all communication that has occurred regarding a topic.

Unfortunately, Mike tells us that e-mail also has a few downsides.

The Bad News:

1. **E-mail lacks privacy.** Mike says that though phone calls made record keeping hard, they ensured privacy. All you needed to do was shut your office door or speak quietly. E-mail, in contrast, inadvertently can be sent to many people.
 2. **E-mail can lead to inaccurate communication.** "Didn't I read somewhere that 65 percent of communication is body language?" Mike asks. This leads to a second problem. With e-mail, the people involved can't see each other's eyes, hand motions, shrugs, smiles, or frowns, nor can they hear the grunts, groans, or laughs. Much of this body language is lost with electronic communication.
 3. **E-mail can be depersonalized.** Body language not only helps communication, but also it personalizes. E-mail, Mike notes, can be impersonal. In some instances, especially those regarding "contentious situations," Mike knows that a face-to-face discussion is the best way to solve a problem. In fact, Mike concludes that some people who are "conflict resistant" use e-mail as a way of avoiding person-to-person communication. To maintain good business relationships (with personnel as well as with customers), face-to-face talks often are needed.
- Still, for speed and efficiency, e-mail is hard to beat.

WRITING EFFECTIVE EMAILS

- Recognize your audience
 - Recognize your audience's level of knowledge, language and technology knowhow
- Use an effective subject line
 - Avoid vague subjects
- Keep emails brief
- Organize your emails
 - Introduction, body/discussion and conclusion
- Proofread

- 
- 
- Be careful while sending attachments
 - Be courteous
 - Be professional – do not forget formal writing conventions just because you are writing an email
 - Do not write in anger

ACTIVITY

Write a letter to a clothing brand, complaining about your recent online purchase. The package that you've received has two defected shirts, the customer service number provided on the website isn't ready to help you and the nearest outlet has also refused you to be of any help.

SOURCE

- Technical Communication: Process and Product, Seventh Edition, by Sharon J. Gerson and Steven M. Gerson. Published by Prentice Hall. Copyright © 2012 by Pearson Education, Inc.